Liota is expected to enhance the development of new IoT devices as it helps to decouple data. Moreover, it eases the analysis and transport of large data to the cloud or data centre.

Linux Foundation backs OpenSwitch networking operating system

The Linux Foundation has announced that it has started backing the OpenSwitch networking operating system. The open source project was originally launched by Hewlett-Packard Enterprise (HPE) last October to offer a special Linux platform for enterprise-grade switches.
"OpenSwitch brings another important ingredient of the open networking stack to the Linux Foundation," said Jim Zemlin, executive director at the Linux Foundation, in a statement. "We're looking forward to working with this community to advance networking across the enterprise," he added.

OpenSwitch lets developers build networks with advanced performance, flexibility and security through protocols. It comes with the capabilities to integrate with other open source technologies such as Broadcom Broadview, Grommit, LLDPD, P4 and OpenVSwitch, among others.

In addition to the prime role by the Linux Foundation, OpenSwitch has members and participating organisations like Barefoot Networks, Broadcom, Cavium, Edgecore Networks, Extreme Networks, LinkedIn, Marvel, Mellanox Technologies and Quattro Networks. HPE is also supporting the platform to deliver an open governance model to enterprises.

Even though the final public version of OpenSwitch is yet to arrive in the market, its preview release is already available. Besides, the Linux Foundation mentions that the platform is accepting contributions "…from all interested companies and developers."

OpenSwitch isn't the only open source networking operating system. Nevertheless, it is the first enterprise-grade community platform that has been supported by industry contributors like HPE, Broadcom, Intel and VMware.

The Linux Foundation is apparently set to expand its presence in the networking project space by backing OpenSwitch. However, it already has projects including OpenDaylight and OpenNFV to take the Linux kernel to new levels.

Red Hat releases Ansible 2.1 with Microsoft Windows and Azure support

Red Hat has announced the release of Ansible 2.1. This new version of the open source IT automation framework is designed to extend its presence from the foundation of the network in an organisation to some container-based deployments.

Unlike its previous versions, Ansible 2.1 comes with extensive Windows and Azure support to deliver an agentless IT deployment experience across both the major Microsoft platforms. There is also expanded support for Docker-formatted Linux containers to offer complete cross-platform automation.

Canonical launches Snapcraft 2.9 tool for Ubuntu 16.04 LTS

Canonical has expanded the existing Snap package support on Ubuntu 16.04 LTS with the launch of its Snapcraft 2.9. The new Snappy creator tool is designed to let you easily create new Snap packages for your software.

Ubuntu 16.04 LTS, codenamed Xenial Xerus, is the first Ubuntu version that brought the Snap package format alongside the traditional Debs. Although the operating system received an update last month to enable Snap support, it didn't have any native tool to let users easily create Snaps or Snappy packages, until now.

Snapcraft 2.9 supports the 'confinement' YAML property with 'devmode' and strict options to enable easy Snap creation. Also, there is support for the 'epoch' YAML property to enable step-by-step upgrades within Snaps.

While the new release is certainly a significant one, if you want to create new Snaps, its confinement YAML property is still unfurnished. You need to specify Snaps if working under the devmode option. "This will allow for snapd to provide reasonable errors if one tries to install a Snap that cannot run successfully under confinement," reads the description on Launchpad.

Snapcraft 2.9 is available for access through the main software repositories of Ubuntu 16.04 LTS. You can install it on your system either using the Ubuntu software graphical package or the APT command-line utility.